

Hostility as a Prospective Mediator of the Relationship Between Treatment Engagement and Decision Making for People in Court-Mandated Substance Use Treatment

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Background

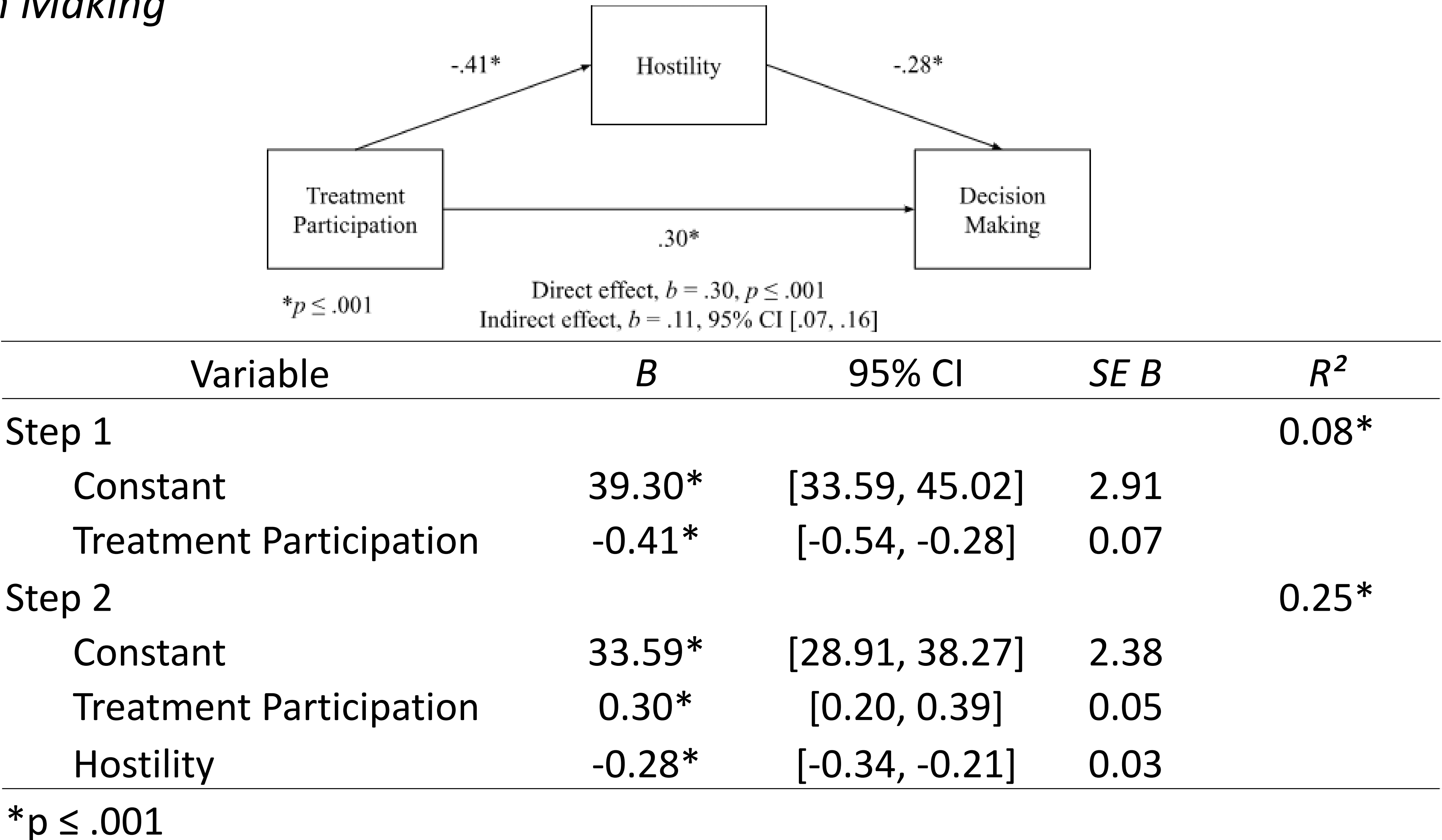
- Treatment participation has been associated with positive post-release outcomes for people enrolled in prison substance use treatment programs (Joe et al., 2001; Kubiak et al., 2006; Yang et al., 2013).
- On the other hand, hostility has been shown to act as a barrier to reintegration, particularly in situations where there is less social support and self-control (Hochstetler et al., 2008).
- The purpose of the current study is to explore the role hostility has in explaining the relationship between treatment participation and positive changes in decision making for people in substance use treatment.

Methods

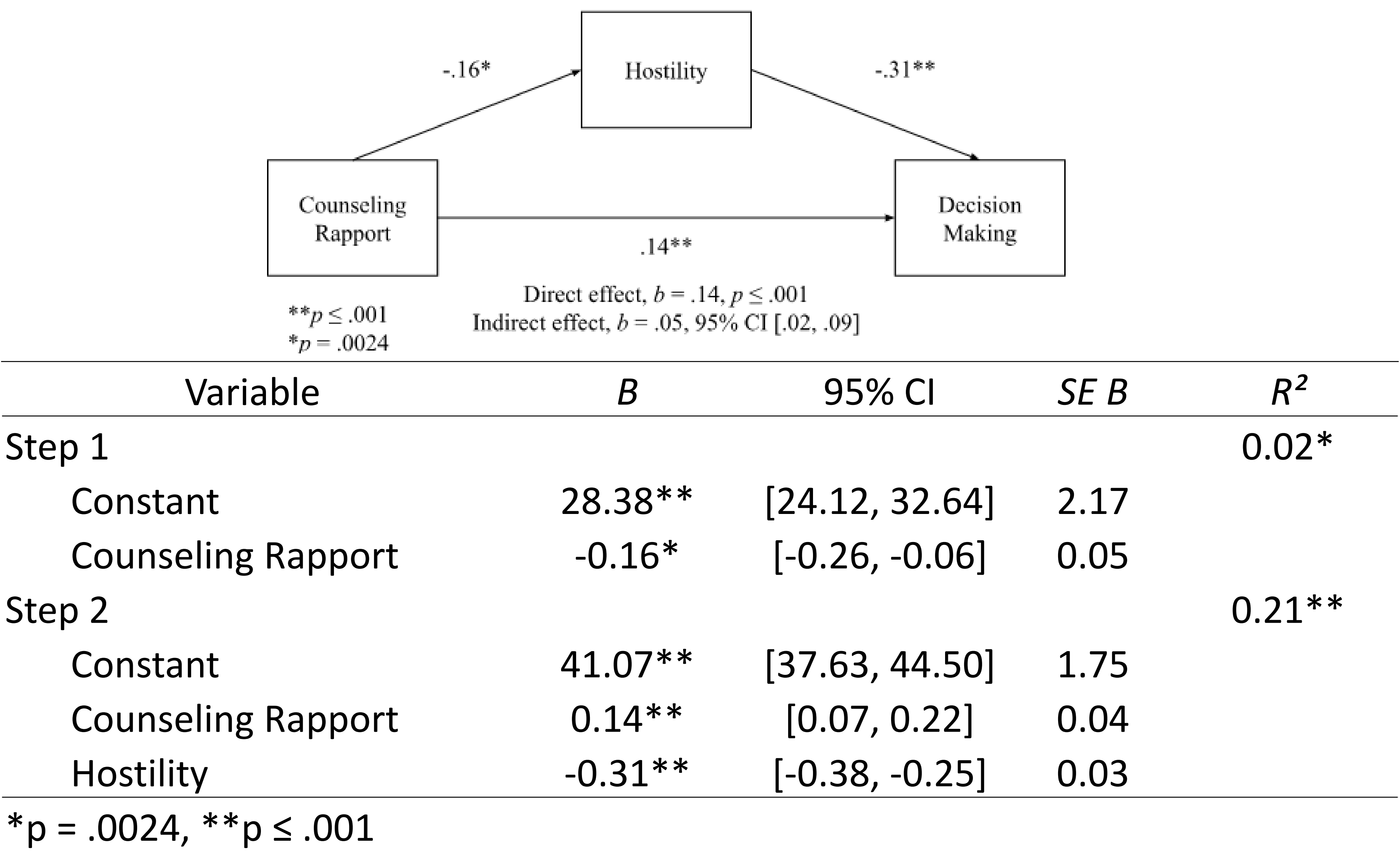
- Data were collected across three timepoints from 455 justice involved individuals participating in residential treatment.
- Results showed that increased treatment participation was associated with decreased hostility, which in turn was associated with improved decision making.
- A similar pattern was observed when examining counselor rapport as the independent variable; increased counseling rapport was associated with decreased hostility, which in turn was associated with improved decision making.

Results

Regression Analysis for Mediation of Hostility between Treatment Participation and Decision Making



Regression Analysis for Mediation of Hostility between Counseling Rapport and Decision Making



Discussion

- Increased treatment participation was associated with decreased hostility, which in turn was associated with improved decision making.
- A similar pattern was observed when examining counselor rapport as the independent variable; increased counseling rapport was associated with decreased hostility, which in turn was associated with improved decision making.

Implications

- The current study showed that decreased hostility may explain some positive post-treatment changes in decision making.
- Evidence-based interventions targeting hostility may have an important role in substance use treatment.
- Researchers and clinicians should consider emphasizing early participation and active involvement to foster a supportive environment, allowing clients to benefit more from treatment.